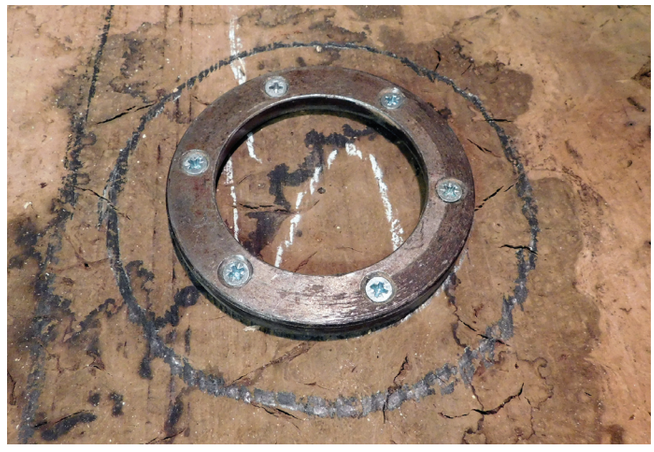
as stress free as possible, and take it slowly.

Cutting with bowl gouges shouldn't present any real problems, but occasionally burr can prove difficult to cut cleanly due to the lack of grain direction. In this situation burr often responds better to a scraper. However this can be problematic: burr, as we have already established, can have voids and bark inclusions and a heavy hand with a scraper can result in a nasty catch on such areas, so take light cuts and keep the cutting edge at about 45° sheer.

Burr with an unusual flaw

Blank ready for turning

Assorted mounting accessories



Faceplate ring attached

Turning and finishing the outer shape

Turning the outside shape is no different than for any other bowl; the process however, can be slower and more physically demanding. The preparation for remounting can be problematic.

Take some time to ensure that all loose bark is removed and then begin to prepare the flat area for a recessed holding point. You can see the potential problem of an incomplete recess. Work back into solid wood until you have enough to form the recess. You may be forced to compromise here, but safety and surety of hold should always be your paramount concern. If in doubt, a sacrificial block could be glued to the flat surface and the holding point cut into it. The block can be turned away later by reverse-turning the bowl. If you choose this option then hot melt glue is the option I generally use, but traditional wood glues can be employed provided sufficient curing time is allowed for. Double check the glued joint prior, and during, any subsequent turning.

Having turned the outer shape, abrade to your chosen finish. With so many voids and irregular edges, abrading burrs is best achieved with a firm pad on an arbor. Use a light touch to avoid the possibility of a catch and of differential abrasion between hard and soft areas.

Loose bark to be removed

Preparing an area for a recess holding point

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